

AI Tools for Learning Design.

Choose the right AI tool for the job, and build faster.

BUILT AROUND THE TRAINERFY360 TOOL SELECTOR

Know which AI tool to use, and when, to create slides, videos, graphics, narration and learning assets without wasting hours comparing tools.

- ✓ AI-Enabled ADDIE: where tools fit in your project lifecycle
- ✓ The Trainerfy360 Tool Selector: four questions that pick the tool
- ✓ The AI Tool-to-Task Matrix: the best tool for every common job
- ✓ AI Agents for Training Questions: platforms to answer repeated questions
- ✓ Tool Scorecard: ease, speed & quality rated out of 5



27 Tasks

Mapped to a best-fit tool



19 Tools

Rated for ease, speed & quality



5 Stages

AI across all of ADDIE



1 Framework

The Tool Selector

You don't need another AI tools list. You need a decision system.

Spending more time evaluating AI tools than building with them is a common trap. Hundreds of options, a new "Top 20" list every week, and deadlines that don't wait.

This guide is a **tool-to-task decision system**: which tool fits which job, and when to use each one.

How to use this guide.

This isn't a cover-to-cover read. Come in with a task and follow this path:

1 Map your project first · Use the AI-Enabled ADDIE table to spot where AI will save you the most time in your current project.

Page 3

2 Answer the four Selector questions · What am I making, what's my input, how much time, how polished? They narrow any task to one or two tools.

Page 4

3 Confirm your pick in the Matrix · Find your task, check why the tool fits and what it's best for. Our recommended stack is there too.

Pages 5–6

4 Copy a recipe · Match your scenario, or follow the SME-notes-to-asset workflow step by step.

Pages 7–8

5 Settle ties with the Scorecard · When two tools both fit, compare ease, speed and output quality before you commit.

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Before you start: if you work with sensitive or regulated data, check your organisation's AI and data policies before uploading SME notes or internal content to cloud-based tools.

AI-Enabled ADDIE.

Where AI creates leverage across the learning lifecycle

AI conversations often focus on tools. Learning projects focus on outcomes. This view maps AI to the work happening inside each ADDIE phase, helping you identify where AI can reduce effort, accelerate drafting and support better decisions.

ADDIE is a widely used learning design process: Analyse, Design, Develop, Implement, Evaluate.

ADDIE STAGE	COMMON TASKS	AI TOOLS THAT HELP	BIGGEST TIME-SAVER
Analyse	Gather needs, clarify objectives, understand audience	ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini, Perplexity, NotebookLM	<i>Upload SME docs and let AI extract themes, gaps and audience questions</i>
Design	Structure content, outline activities, draft scripts	ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini, Canva	<i>Draft outlines, learning objectives, and activity ideas in minutes</i>
Develop	Build slides, videos, graphics, eLearning	Gamma, Rise, Storyline, HeyGen, Vyond, ElevenLabs, Canva, Descript	<i>Build slides, video, audio, eLearning at 3-5× speed</i>
Implement	Deploy through LMS, deliver workshops, share videos	LMS, 360Learning, video platforms, Camtasia	<i>Auto-caption, transcript, distribute via LMS or video platform</i>
Evaluate	Collect feedback, analyse results, iterate	ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini, forms, survey tools, LMS analytics	<i>Summarise feedback, suggest improvements, draft survey questions</i>

The same tool can appear at several stages, ADDIE isn't a straight line. Choose by task, not by stage alone. This is a map, not a shackle.

The Trainerfy360 Tool Selector.

Four questions that pick the right tool, every time

I was losing hours auditioning every new AI tool instead of building with the ones that work. Four simple questions brought clarity: start with the task, the input, the deadline and the finish, and the right tool usually becomes obvious. AI should support judgement, not replace it.

Answer all four and the shortlist is usually one or two tools. Confirm the fit in the matrix on the next page.



1 · What am I making?

- Slides → Gamma, Canva or Claude (.pptx)
- Video → HeyGen, Synthesia or Vyond
- eLearning → Rise or Storyline
- Audio → ElevenLabs or Descript
- Images → Canva AI, Adobe Express, Midjourney, DALL·E 3
- Documents & surveys → Claude, ChatGPT or Gemini



2 · What's my input?

- SME notes → Claude, ChatGPT, NotebookLM
- Recorded footage → Descript, Camtasia
- A brief or outline → Gamma, Rise, HeyGen
- A prompt only → Midjourney, DALL·E 3, Vyond
- Feedback data → ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini
- Policy documents → NotebookLM, Claude



3 · How much time do I have?

- Under an hour → Gamma, HeyGen, ElevenLabs
- Half a day → Rise, Vyond, Descript
- A full build → Storyline, Camtasia
- Ongoing → Claude, ChatGPT, NotebookLM



4 · How polished must it be?

- First draft or internal → Gamma, ChatGPT
- Client-ready and branded → Canva, Claude
- Publication-quality → Midjourney, Storyline, Camtasia
- Compliance content → AI drafts, SME sign-off

The AI Tool-to-Task Matrix.

For each task, here's the best tool and why.

TASK	RECOMMENDED TOOL	WHY IT FITS	BEST FOR
Writing & ideation			
Run role plays and conversation practice	ChatGPT or Claude	Plays the other character, adapts, gives feedback	Difficult conversations, coaching and feedback practice
Summarise SME notes into content	ChatGPT or Claude	Great at distilling, organising, drafting	Turning messy input into usable content
Draft scripts, outlines, and course copy	Claude (Anthropic)	Strong at long-form, nuanced writing and analysis	Scripts, storyboards, outlines, learning content drafts
Draft and summarise inside Microsoft 365	Microsoft 365 Copilot	AI embedded in Word, PowerPoint, Teams and Outlook	Meeting transcripts to action items, first-pass drafts in your own files
Research & synthesis			
Research trends, tools, data	Perplexity or Gemini	Fast, cited answers, research-friendly	Quick fact-checks, trend scans, background research
Scan social commentary and live trends	Grok (xAI)	Real-time access to X posts and live discussion	Social sentiment, emerging topics, what practitioners are saying
Synthesise research, source docs, SME content	NotebookLM	Upload sources, ask questions, audio overviews	Deep research synthesis, dense docs into usable content
Research, ideation, Google Workspace tasks	Gemini (Google)	Tight Google integration, multimodal, fast	Teams in Google Workspace, research + drafting combined
Compare AI model outputs side by side	Multi (getmulti.ai)	Run any prompt across multiple models simultaneously	Prompt testing, picking the best model for a task
Design & visuals			
Create a workshop deck from scratch	Gamma	Fast structure, clean slides, minimal friction	Quick decks, first drafts, time-crunch days
Refine and brand existing slides	Canva	Magic Edit, brand kits, easy polish	Making things look "done" without a designer
Create an editable slide deck (.pptx)	Claude (pptx skill)	Generates editable PowerPoint files directly from notes or a brief	Decks you'll finish in PowerPoint, branded templates
Create an infographic or job aid	Canva AI	Templates, Magic Edit, fast visuals	Quick graphics that don't look generic
Create motion graphics or animated photos	Canva AI	Magic Animate, animated text + photo effects	Animated intros, social-style clips, slides with movement
Create polished, branded imagery	Midjourney or DALL-E 3	Better quality, more style control	Professional visuals, branded imagery
Create quick concept images	ChatGPT	Fast concept art, quick visuals	Brainstorming, rough concepts, placeholder art

The AI Tool-to-Task Matrix (continued).

TASK	RECOMMENDED TOOL	WHY IT FITS	BEST FOR
Video & narration			
Create a realistic avatar video	HeyGen	Realistic, cinematic AI avatars, nuanced script-to-video	Presenter-led video, onboarding, training at scale
Create a personalised avatar of you	HeyGen	Best-in-class personalised avatar cloning	Trainer-led content at scale, personal brand videos
Create videos with stock avatars	Synthesia	Polished library of generic avatars	Corporate training where any presenter works
Create a short explainer video (animation)	Vyond	AI scripts, scenes, characters, animation	Animated training, scenarios, storytelling
Create illustrated characters and scenes	Vyond	Character builder, scene and prop libraries	Scenario illustrations, character-led learning
Create narration without hiring talent	ElevenLabs	Natural-sounding voice, voice cloning	Voiceover without mic stress or studio time
Edit video + add captions easily	Descript	Edit video by editing text, captions, overdub	Fast video edits, captioning, quick fixes
Record software training	Camtasia	Screen recording + editing in one tool	Software demos, step-by-step training
Course building & interactivity			
Create a web-based course quickly	Rise (Articulate 360)	Fast authoring, responsive design, AI-assisted	Mobile-friendly courses, quick rollouts
Build interactive eLearning	Storyline	Full control, scenarios, branching	eLearning that feels real, not generic
Collaborative course creation + LMS	360Learning	AI-assisted creation, collaborative LMS	Teams that want creation + distribution together

What's coming

Articulate has announced **AI avatar video generation for Articulate 360**, currently previewing through its Articulate Labs early-access program. If you build in Rise or Storyline, watch this space: avatars inside your authoring tool could simplify the whole video step. The bigger shift on the horizon is from tools to systems, agents and workflow builders (such as Copilot Studio) that turn one-off AI help into repeatable team processes.

New to AI? Start with ChatGPT or Claude, Canva and Gamma. Most designers get 80% of the productivity gain from those three alone.

Common L&D Scenarios: "I need..."

How the system looks in practice, when the clock is ticking

Start with the task, not the tool. The examples below show how the decision system works in real learning design scenarios.

I NEED...	USE THIS	WHY
A workshop deck by tomorrow.	Gamma + Canva	Fast draft, then quick polish.
A three-minute compliance explainer.	Claude → HeyGen + ElevenLabs	Script first, then straight to avatar video and narration.
Scenario-based dialogue for role plays.	ChatGPT or Claude	Plays the other character, adapts, gives feedback.
An animated scenario story.	Vyond	Characters, scenes and storytelling without a studio.
Branching decision practice.	Storyline	Realistic choices with consequences, full control.
To prototype a course fast.	ChatGPT or Claude → Gamma → Storyline	Fast draft → quick structure → interactive prototype (full workflow: page 8).
To turn messy SME notes into something usable.	Claude or ChatGPT	Refining, not rewriting from scratch.
To record a software demo.	Camtasia	Industry standard for a reason.

COMMON AI TOOL MISTAKES

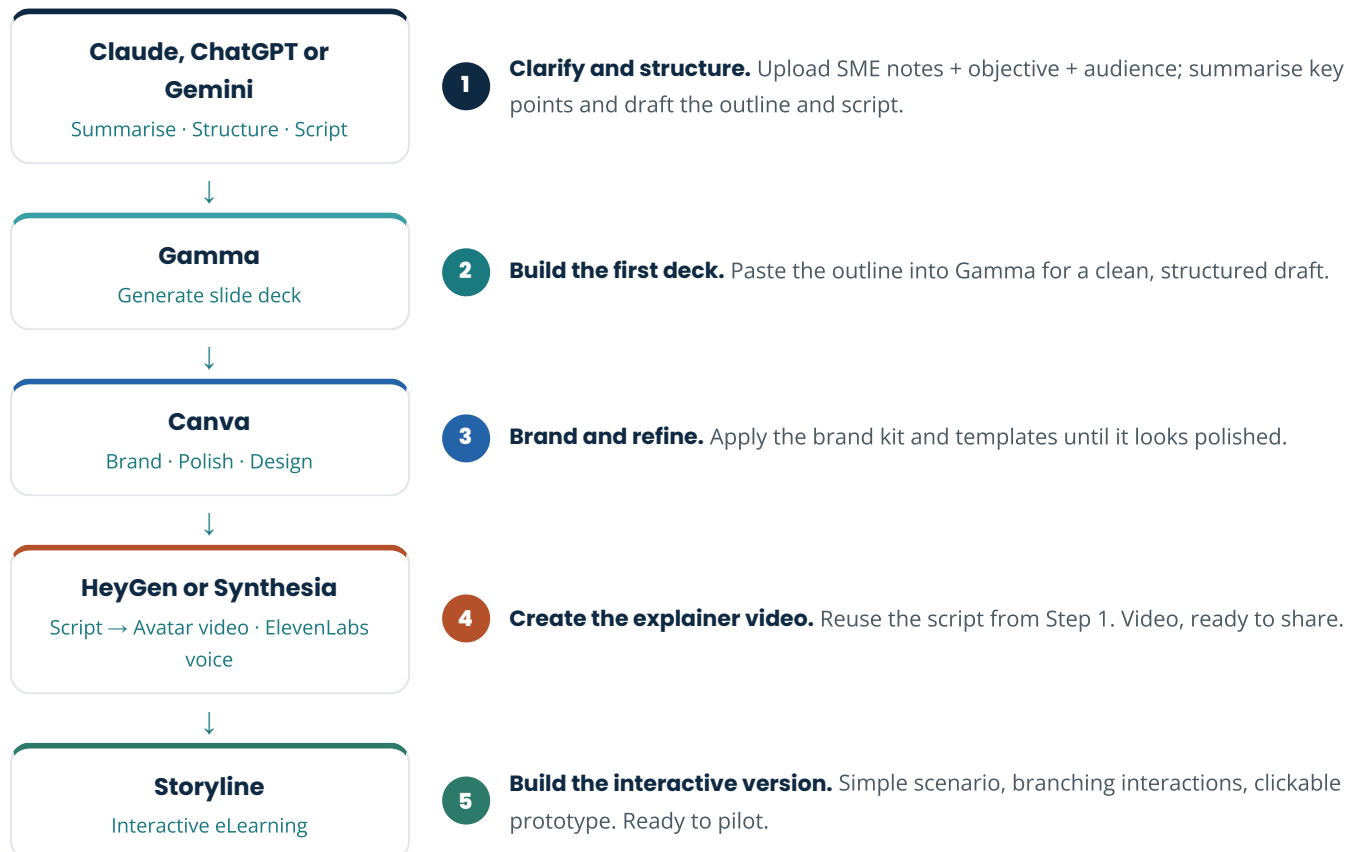
- Buying five tools before mastering one
- Choosing flashy tools over fit-for-purpose ones
- Using AI before clarifying the learning problem
- Creating content before validating it
- Thinking better tools fix weak prompts
- Ignoring privacy, accessibility and governance

From SME Notes to Learning Asset.

What happens between SME input and a finished learning asset is where instructional design expertise creates value.

This is the bit you can't easily Google: a real workflow, from chaos to asset, with decisions and sequencing.

Input → SME notes (Word doc brain dump) · One learning objective · Audience: new managers · Deadline: end of week



Time → AI accelerates every step, allowing more time for review, refinement and learning design decisions.

Working with internal or regulated content? Check your organisation's AI policy before step 1.

Tool Scorecard.

Ease · Speed · Output Quality · rated out of 5

A quick sanity check for when you're weighing up your options. Ratings reflect practical L&D use, not feature lists, and account for editing time, adoption friction and workflow fit.

TOOL	EASE	SPEED	OUTPUT QUALITY	SWEET SPOT
Adobe Express	●●●●○	●●●●○	●●●●○	Fast branded visuals, quick graphics and simple L&D assets
Camtasia	●●●●○	●●●○○	●●●●○	Screen recording + software demos
Canva / Canva AI	●●●●○	●●●●○	●●●●○	Brand polish, graphics, job aids
ChatGPT	●●●●●	●●●●●	●●●●○	The default L&D workhorse: outlines, objectives, scripts, scenarios, job aids
Claude	●●●●●	●●●●●	●●●●●	Long-form, nuanced content + analysis
Descript	●●●●○	●●●●○	●●●●○	Video edits + captions quickly
ElevenLabs	●●●●○	●●●●●	●●●●●	Natural narration, no mic needed
Gamma	●●●●○	●●●●●	●●●○○	First drafts, structure & storyboarding, then polish in Canva
Gemini	●●●●○	●●●●○	●●●○○	Google Workspace + fast research
HeyGen	●●●○○	●●●●○	●●●○○	Short explainer videos, best under 10 min; longer content can be costly and unstable
Microsoft 365 Copilot	●●●●○	●●●●○	●●●●○	Drafting in Word, PowerPoint, Teams and Outlook; meeting summaries
Midjourney	●●●○○	●●●○○	●●●●●	High-quality professional imagery
Multi	●●●●●	●●●●○	●●●●○	Compare models, pick the best output
NotebookLM	●●●●○	●●●●○	●●●●○	Deep synthesis from source docs
Perplexity	●●●●●	●●●●●	●●●●○	Cited research, trend scans
Rise	●●●●●	●●●●○	●●●○○	Fast responsive web courses
Storyline	●●○○○	●●○○○	●●●●●	Complex interactivity, full control
Synthesia	●●●●○	●●●●○	●●●○○	Stock-avatar corporate video, strong multi-language support
Vyond	●●●○○	●●●●○	●●●●○	Animated scenarios and storytelling

5/5 = best in class · 2/5 = works, but expect friction. Ratings reflect real-world instructional design use, not vendor feature lists.

AI Agents for Training Questions.

Bot and assistant platforms for answering repeated training questions

A fully custom bot isn't usually the right starting point. Begin with a reliable knowledge-base assistant trained on approved content, and move to custom development only if advanced workflows or tighter integration demand it.

USE CASE	GOOD OPTIONS	BEST FOR	WHY IT FITS
Fast FAQ bot	Jotform AI Agents, Zoho SalesIQ and similar no-code builders	Simple training questions, FAQs, learner support	<i>Quick to set up and easy to maintain</i>
Knowledge-base assistant	Microsoft document Q&A, enterprise knowledge-assistant tools	Answers grounded in approved policies, guides and training docs	<i>Better control over accuracy and source content</i>
Learning platform bot	Built-in AI agents inside enterprise learning platforms	Compliance support, learner guidance, internal workflows	<i>Fits the existing learning ecosystem</i>
Custom conversational assistant	Custom builds using AI frameworks and APIs	Branded assistants, complex workflows, advanced logic	<i>High flexibility, but needs technical support</i>
Research and synthesis assistant	Source-based Q&A tools (notebook-style assistants)	Summarising training materials, extracting answers from documents	<i>Great for internal knowledge and content review</i>

Where to start: treat agents as a faster way to answer repeated training questions from approved content, not as magic. Quick pilot or small team? Start with a no-code bot builder. Enterprise L&D? A knowledge-base assistant or learning-platform bot. Move to a custom build only when you need advanced workflows or deeper integration.

Want to go deeper?

You don't need to be an AI expert. You just need a better system.



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I've spent more than 20 years designing learning across corporate, government and higher education.

When AI arrived, I saw talented instructional designers facing a new challenge: not learning the technology, but figuring out how to use it without sacrificing quality, judgement and good learning design.

That's why I created resources like this guide and the **Tool Selector**, practical systems to help L&D professionals work smarter with AI, without losing what makes great learning design great.



20+

Years in Learning Design



2

Industry Awards



Creator

AI-Enabled ADDIE Orbit

Want the prompts behind the tools?

The companion guide: **AI Prompts for Learning Design**, built on the C.R.A.F.T.™ framework.

- The C.R.A.F.T. framework for sharper prompts
- 11 prompts for slides, scripts and content
- A repeatable system for better AI outputs



Download AI Prompts for Learning Design · trainerfy360.com/craft

Want to transform your whole workflow?

The companion guide: **Transforming L&D Workflows**, AI across every ADDIE phase.

- Traditional vs AI across all five ADDIE phases
- Where AI saves the most time, stage by stage
- Governance and safety built into every phase



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